

NATIONAL CYBERCRIME INVESTIGATION AGENCY

NCCIA - PAKISTAN

Comprehensive Knowledge Base for RAG Systems

Cybercrime Reporting • Office Directories • PECA 2016 (as amended to 2025) •
Complaint Procedures

Version 1.1 | Revised September 2026

Legal sections (Parts 1, 4, 6, 7, 9) revised against the Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act, 2016 as amended up to Act No. II of 2025, and the PECA Investigation Rules, 2018.

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1. Overview of NCCIA

The National Cybercrime Investigation Agency (NCCIA) is Pakistan's dedicated federal agency responsible for the inquiry into, investigation and prosecution of offences under the Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act (PECA) 2016, and for preventing cybercrime across the country. It works to safeguard sensitive information and uphold the integrity of Pakistan's digital space.

Mission Statement

NCCIA is dedicated to addressing cybercrime challenges head-on through proactive measures and thorough investigations. The agency aims to safeguard sensitive information and uphold the integrity of the digital space. By leveraging Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), NCCIA continuously monitors and assesses its effectiveness, ensuring prompt adaptation to emerging threats. Through its commitment to innovation and excellence, NCCIA strives to create a safer online environment for every citizen of Pakistan.

Key Functions & Responsibilities

- Inquiry, investigation and prosecution of cybercrime offences under PECA 2016 (Section 29)
- Proactive monitoring of digital threats and vulnerabilities
- Receiving, processing, and investigating public cybercrime complaints
- Coordinating with banks, telecom providers, and digital platforms for evidence gathering
- Issuing notices, applying to the Court for warrants (Sections 33 and 34), and registering FIRs in cybercrime cases
- Blocking fraudulent transactions and bank accounts upon verified evidence
- International cooperation in cross-border cybercrime investigations (Section 42)
- Public awareness campaigns on cybersecurity hygiene
- Forensic analysis of digital evidence
- Liaison with courts for prosecution of cybercrime offenders

Website	https://www.nccia.gov.pk
General Helpdesk	helpdesk@nccia.gov.pk
Operational Scope	Nationwide - 15 Circle Offices across all provinces and territories
Legal Authority	Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act (PECA) 2016, Act No. XL of 2016, as amended by Act No. XXXVII of 2023 and the Prevention of Electronic Crimes (Amendment) Act 2025 (Act No. II of 2025, dated 29 January 2025)
Legal Basis of the Agency	Section 29 of PECA (as substituted by Act No. II of 2025): the Federal Government establishes the National Cyber Crime Investigation Agency (NCCIA) for inquiry into, investigation and prosecution of offences under the Act. It is headed by a Director General appointed by the Federal Government for a non-extendable term of three years.
Predecessor	Upon establishment of the NCCIA, the Cyber Crime Wing of the Federal Investigation Agency (FIA) ceased to exist; its personnel, cases, inquiries, investigations, assets and liabilities stand transferred to the NCCIA (Section 29(4)). Until the NCCIA and the Authority were established, the previous investigation agency continued to perform its functions (Section 50A).
Powers of Officers	For inquiry and investigation, NCCIA officers are deemed police officers of equivalent rank under the Code of Criminal Procedure 1898 and have the same powers and functions (Section 29(3)).
Rules	Rules made under PECA before the 2025 Amendment (including the PECA Investigation Rules 2018) apply to the NCCIA mutatis mutandis (Section 29(8)).
Parent Ministry	Ministry of Interior, Government of Pakistan

2. NCCIA Circle Offices - National Directory

NCCIA operates 15 Cybercrime Reporting Centres (CCRCs) across Pakistan. Victims of cybercrime can report incidents at any of the offices listed below. Each office is headed by an Officer In-Charge (Circle In-Charge) who can be contacted directly.

City	Phone	Email	Address
Islamabad	+92 51 9262106	incharge.ccrcc.ict@nccia.gov.pk	Plaza 5/C, Street No. 169, G-13/3, Islamabad
Rawalpindi	+92 51 9330719	incharge.ccrcc.rwp@nccia.gov.pk	House No 162/2, Punj Sarrki, Near Shell Petrol Pump, Adam Jee Road, Sadar, Rawalpindi
Peshawar	+92 91 9216251	incharge.ccrcc.psh@nccia.gov.pk	Lavargini Flats, Abdara Road, Peshawar
Abbottabad	+92 992 921588	incharge.ccrcc.atd@nccia.gov.pk	House No 62, Near Bilal Masjid, Bilal Town, PMA Road, Abbottabad
Dera Ismail Khan	+92 96 710537	incharge.ccrcc.dik@nccia.gov.pk	25-A Shami Road, Near Alnoor Masjid, Cantonment, Dera Ismail Khan
Gilgit	+92 5811 960707	incharge.ccrcc.glt@nccia.gov.pk	Near GDA Office, River Road, Chinarbagh, Gilgit
Karachi	+92 21 99333950	incharge.ccrcc.khi@nccia.gov.pk	Near Darul Sehat Hospital, Gulistan-e-Johar, Karachi
Sukkur	+92 71 9310849	incharge.ccrcc.skr@nccia.gov.pk	House No A-126, Sindh Housing Society, Near Nadra Office, Airport Road, Sukkur
Hyderabad	+92 22 9250010	incharge.ccrcc.hyd@nccia.gov.pk	Plot A-100, SITE Area, Near Custom House, Hyderabad
Quetta	+92 81 9330001	incharge.ccrcc.qta@nccia.gov.pk	Banglow No. 105, Tajikabad, Adjacent to Spirit School, Main Killi Shabo Road, Quetta
Gawadar	+92 86 4210118	incharge.ccrcc.gwa@nccia.gov.pk	Plot-M 15, NA Block, Street No. 06, New Town Phase-01, Gawadar
Lahore	+92 42 99268527	incharge.ccrcc.lhr@nccia.gov.pk	8 B, G Block, Gulberg-II, Lahore
Gujranwala	+92 55 9330015	incharge.ccrcc.guj@nccia.gov.pk	Ghaus Plaza, Commercial Area, City Housing Society, Lahore Road, Gujranwala
Faisalabad	+92 41 9330865	incharge.ccrcc.fsl@nccia.gov.pk	Zia Town, Street No 2, East Canal Road, Near Kashmir Pul (Opp. Gohar Textile), Faisalabad
Multan	+92 61 9330999	incharge.ccrcc.mtn@nccia.gov.pk	House No. 06, Street-3, Shalimar Town, Bosan Town, Multan

NOTE: All CCRC email addresses follow the format: incharge.ccrcc.[city-code]@nccia.gov.pk. For the NCCIA Headquarters general enquiries, use: helpdesk@nccia.gov.pk

3. Complaint Filing Procedure

NCCIA provides multiple channels for citizens to report cybercrime. Complainants should bring or submit relevant supporting documents along with their complaint.

Available Channels to File a Complaint

Channel 1: Visit Nearest CCRC Office	Walk in to the nearest NCCIA Circle office with your supporting documents. Speak to the duty officer who will register your complaint.
Channel 2: Email to General Helpdesk	Send an email to helpdesk@nccia.gov.pk with a detailed description of the crime and all supporting documents attached.
Channel 3: Email to Circle Incharge	Email your nearest Circle's Officer In-Charge directly using the email from the directory in Section 2. Include all evidence and a written complaint.
Channel 4: Visit NCCIA Headquarters	Visit the NCCIA HQ in person with a written complaint and supporting documents. The helpdesk at HQ will process and route your complaint to the relevant circle.

Legal basis (PECA Investigation Rules 2018, Rule 6): Each Cybercrime Reporting Centre has a helpdesk of duty officers under the Circle In-Charge, and a complainant may file a complaint in person, via email, fax, telephone or other available digital means to a Cybercrime Reporting Centre (Rule 6(3)). Under Section 2 of PECA a "complainant" includes the victim and any individual having substantial reasons to believe an offence has been, or is likely to be, committed.

Supporting Documents to Attach

Providing complete documentation speeds up your complaint processing:

- CNIC / National Identity Card (copy)
- Screenshots of the fraudulent transaction, message, or content
- Bank statements or transaction records (if financial fraud is involved)
- Email headers and original emails (in cyberstalking or phishing cases)
- URLs, social media profiles, or usernames of the suspected offender
- Written complaint detailing dates, amounts, and sequence of events
- Any previous correspondence with the accused or platform
- Police report (if already filed at the local police station)

4. Complaint Process Flow - From Filing to Trial

Once a complaint is filed, it goes through a structured legal process under PECA 2016, the PECA Investigation Rules 2018 and the Code of Criminal Procedure 1898 (Section 29(5) of PECA requires the agency to follow the Code except where the Act provides otherwise). Understanding each stage helps complainants cooperate effectively with the investigation.

Step 1: Complaint Filed	Complaint received at CCRC office, helpdesk email, or NCCIA HQ. Complainant submits written complaint and supporting documents.
Step 2: Physical Verification	Complainant must visit the office in person to verify the complaint along with relevant documents. CRITICAL: Failure to appear will result in the complaint being CLOSED.
Step 3: Enquiry Registration	After verification, an Enquiry is formally registered. An Enquiry Officer (EO) is assigned.
Step 4: Enquiry / Investigation	The Enquiry Officer collects data, records statements, gathers evidence, and examines digital artifacts related to the enquiry. The EO may issue notices to the complainant and suspects. Under Rule 7(3) of the Investigation Rules 2018, the investigation officer submits an investigation report within sixty days from the date of registration of the case.
Step 5: FIR Registration	If sufficient evidence is found and approved by the competent authority, the EO recommends registration of a First Information Report (FIR) under the applicable PECA sections. Cognizable offences (Sections 10, 13, 14, 20, 21, 22, 22A, 22B, 22C and 26A and abetment): the Circle In-Charge orders registration after seeking legal opinion and with prior approval of the Additional Director of the zone (Rule 7(4)). Non-cognizable offences (all other PECA offences): the Circle In-Charge must first seek permission of the competent Court for investigation under Section 155 of the Code (Rule 7(5)).
Step 6: Arrest of Accused	Following FIR registration, the accused is arrested as per the law. A detained accused must be produced before the Court within 24 hours of arrest (excluding journey time). Police/agency remand may not exceed 14 days at one time and 30 days in total (Section 30A).
Step 7: Challan Submission	The investigation challan (charge sheet) is submitted in the competent court for trial proceedings (final challan under Section 173 of the Code, Rule 7(6)).
Step 8: Court Trial	The case proceeds to trial before a Court designated under Section 44. The court examines evidence, hears arguments, and delivers judgment. Trials of offences against minors are held in-camera (Section 30C). An appeal lies within 30 days to the High Court (against a Sessions Court judgment) or to the Court of Session (against a Magistrate's judgment) - Section 47.

IMPORTANT: The complainant's active participation is essential throughout the process. Failure to respond to notices or appear before the Enquiry Officer may lead to the complaint being closed or, in serious cases, legal action against the complainant for non-cooperation.

5. Bank Account Blocking - FAQs & Procedures

One of the most common queries received by NCCIA relates to blocked bank accounts. This section answers the most Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) about account blocking, notices, and how to respond.

Q1: Why has NCCIA blocked my bank account?

NCCIA blocks bank accounts when a fraudulent or suspicious amount has been received in the account. If your account has been blocked, it means NCCIA has identified a transaction in your account that is linked to a cybercrime complaint or investigation. The block is a precautionary measure taken in the course of an investigation, to preserve evidence and prevent further movement of potentially fraudulent funds. NCCIA officers exercise the investigative powers of police officers under the Code of Criminal Procedure 1898 (PECA Section 29(3) and (5)).

Q2: What happens after my account is blocked?

After blocking the account, the concerned Enquiry Officer or Case Officer serves you a formal notice asking you to justify the flagged transaction(s). You are required to explain the source and legitimacy of the amount(s) received in your account.

Q3: How do I respond if I have evidence that the amount was genuinely fraudulent?

If you are a victim who received the fraudulent amount unknowingly: (1) Visit the relevant NCCIA Circle Office in person, (2) Bring all supporting documents related to the transaction (bank statements, transaction receipts, communications), (3) Submit the documents to the Enquiry Officer with a written explanation. Your account block will be reviewed and lifted if the evidence is satisfactory.

Q4: What if I cannot physically visit the office?

If you are located away from the concerned NCCIA office, you may submit all relevant documents related to the transactions to the Enquiry Officer via a reliable Courier Service. Ensure the documents are complete, certified where needed, and accompanied by a written explanation.

Q5: How do I find out which officer or circle has blocked my account?

You should contact the Helpdesk / Customer Care of your concerned bank. Request the following: (1) Name of the Enquiry Officer who issued the blocking order, (2) Enquiry Number associated with your case, (3) Address of the NCCIA Circle that issued the order. Your bank is required to provide this information to you.

Q6: What if I have not responded to notices issued by the Enquiry Officer?

If you fail to join the NCCIA office despite THREE notices being issued, the Enquiry Officer has the legal authority to register a criminal case (FIR) against you, provided sufficient evidence exists. The notices are served to hear your version or explanation. Ignoring notices is treated as non-cooperation in a criminal investigation.

Q7: What is the purpose of the Enquiry Officer's notices to me?

The notices are meant to give you a fair opportunity to present your side of the case. NCCIA follows due process under PECA 2016 and the Code of Criminal Procedure 1898. You have the right to explain the nature of transactions in your account before any FIR is registered against you.

Q8: Can I consult a lawyer?

Yes. You have the right to legal representation at all stages of the enquiry and trial process. It is strongly advised that you consult a lawyer experienced in cybercrime and PECA cases if your account has been blocked or you have received notices.

6. Legal Framework - Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act (PECA) 2016

NCCIA operates under the Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act, 2016 (PECA), Act No. XL of 2016 (dated 19 August 2016). This is the primary legislation governing cybercrime in Pakistan. The Act has been amended by the Prevention of Electronic Crimes (Amendment) Act, 2023 (Act No. XXXVII of 2023) and the Prevention of Electronic Crimes (Amendment) Act, 2025 (Act No. II of 2025, dated 29 January 2025).

Background & Scope

PECA was enacted to prevent unauthorized acts with respect to information systems and to provide for related offences as well as mechanisms for their investigation, prosecution, trial and international cooperation (Preamble).

Extent and application (Section 1): The Act extends to the whole of Pakistan. It applies to every citizen of Pakistan wherever he may be and to every other person for the time being in Pakistan. It also applies to any act committed outside Pakistan by any person if the act constitutes an offence under the Act and affects a person, property, information system or data located in Pakistan.

Structure of the Act (as amended to 2025)

Chapter	Sections	Subject
I - Preliminary	1-2	Short title, extent, application and commencement; definitions.
IA - Authority	2A-2P	Establishment, powers, composition and functioning of the Social Media Protection and Regulatory Authority (the "Authority"), which replaces the PTA in the Act's blocking and removal functions. Includes Section 2C (complaint to the Authority on fake information; order within 24 hours).
IB - Enlistment etc.	2Q-2U	Enlistment of social media platforms; unlawful or offensive online content; complaint handling by platforms; Social Media Complaint Council; violation or non-implementation of Authority directions.
IC - Social Media Protection Tribunal	2V-2X	Tribunals (to decide cases within 90 days); jurisdiction and appeals from Authority decisions; appeal to the Supreme Court of Pakistan within 60 days.
II - Offences and Punishments	3-28	All substantive cyber offences and penalties (see Part 7).
III - Investigation Agency and Procedural Powers	29-41	The NCCIA (Section 29), power to investigate (30), remand (30A), victim and witness protection (30B), in-camera trial (30C), preservation of data (31), traffic data retention (32), search/seizure warrants (33), content-data warrants (34), powers of authorized officers (35-36), unlawful online content (37), service-provider liability (38), real-time collection (39), forensic laboratory (40), confidentiality (41).
IV - International Cooperation	42	Cooperation with foreign governments, agencies and international organizations.
V - Prosecution and Trial of Offences	43-47	Cognizable/bailable/compoundable status (43), complaints on crimes against children (43A), designated courts (44), compensation (45), victim support (45A), amicus curiae and expert opinion (46), appeal (47).
VI - Preventive Measures	48-49	Directives to prevent electronic crimes; computer emergency response teams.
VII - Miscellaneous	50-55	Relation with other laws (50), transitory provision (50A), rule-making (51), regulations (51A), removal of difficulties (52), report to Parliament (53), amendment of the Electronic Transactions Ordinance 2002 (54), savings (55).

Key Institutions Created or Reshaped by the 2025 Amendment

- **NCCIA (Section 29):** replaces the FIA Cyber Crime Wing as the investigation agency; headed by a Director General (non-extendable three-year term).
- **Social Media Protection and Regulatory Authority (Sections 2A-2P):** regulates unlawful or offensive content on social media platforms, may direct removal or blocking of content, and hears applications from aggrieved persons (for example under Sections 16, 20, 21, 22, 24 and 24A). Its blocking directions under Section 2B(1)(I) run for 30 days, extendable once by up to a further 30 days.
- **Section 37 (Unlawful on-line content):** the Authority may remove or block information in the interest of the glory of Islam or the integrity, security or defence of Pakistan, public order, decency or morality, contempt of

court, or incitement to an offence. An aggrieved person may seek review by the Authority within 30 days, and appeal to the High Court within 30 days of the review order.

- **Social Media Protection Tribunal (Sections 2V-2X):** hears appeals against Authority decisions and must decide cases within 90 days; appeal lies to the Supreme Court within 60 days.
- **Section 26A (new):** punishment for false and fake information (see Part 7).

Investigation Powers Under PECA

- Expedited preservation and acquisition of data by written notice - preservation for a period not exceeding 90 days, extendable by the Court; the Court must be informed within 24 hours (Section 31)
- Retention of traffic data by service providers for a minimum of one year (or as notified by the Authority), disclosed on a Court warrant (Section 32)
- Court warrants for search and seizure of information systems, data and devices (Section 33); warrantless search only in the circumstances of Section 33(2) (offence under Section 10, by a Gazetted officer, with Court informed within 24 hours)
- Court warrants for disclosure of content data (Section 34)
- Powers of authorized officers, including access to and inspection of systems, copying of relevant data, and requiring decryption (Section 35), subject to proportionality and chain-of-custody safeguards (Sections 35-36)
- Real-time collection and recording of information by order of the Court, for not more than seven days unless extended (Section 39)
- Forensic analysis of digital devices and data; the forensic laboratory is independent of the investigation agency (Sections 29(6) and 40)
- Removal or blocking of unlawful online content, now by the Authority (Sections 2B, 2R and 37) rather than the PTA
- International cooperation and mutual assistance (Section 42)

Relation with Other Laws (Section 50)

PECA has effect not in derogation of the Pakistan Penal Code 1860, the Code of Criminal Procedure 1898, the Qanoon-e-Shahadat Order 1984, the Protection of Pakistan Act 2014 and the Investigation for Fair Trial Act 2013. Subject to that, the Act has effect notwithstanding anything to the contrary in any other law on the subject. The provisions of the Pakistan Penal Code 1860 apply to PECA offences to the extent not inconsistent with the Act (Section 28).

Cognizance, Bail and Compounding (Section 43)

- **Cognizable, non-bailable and non-compoundable:** offences under Sections 10, 13, 14, 20, 21, 22, 22A, 22B, 22C and 26A, and abetment of them.
- **All other PECA offences** are non-cognizable, bailable and compoundable. Offences under Section 17 (unauthorized issuance of SIM cards) are cognizable by the investigation agency on a written complaint by the Authority.
- Prosecution and trial of an offence committed by a minor follows the Juvenile Justice System Ordinance 2000 (Section 44(3)). The Court may order compensation to the victim in addition to punishment (Section 45).

7. Key PECA 2016 Offences & Penalties - Quick Reference

Source: Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act, 2016, Chapter II (Sections 3-26A) and related sections, as amended up to Act No. II of 2025. "CI" means critical infrastructure. Amounts are maximum fines unless stated. Cognizance column reflects Section 43.

Sec	Offence	Penalty	Cognizance (s.43)
3	Unauthorized access to information system or data - gaining access with dishonest intention	Up to 3 months imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 50,000 OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
4	Unauthorized copying or transmission of data - with dishonest intention and without authorization	Up to 6 months imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 100,000 OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
5	Interference with information system or data - damaging or interfering with dishonest intention	Up to 2 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 500,000 OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
6	Unauthorized access to CI information system or data	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 1 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
7	Unauthorized copying or transmission of CI data	Up to 5 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 5 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
8	Interference with CI information system or data	Up to 7 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 10 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
9	Glorification of an offence - glorifying terrorism offences, convicted terrorists or proscribed organizations	Up to 7 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 10 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
10	Cyber terrorism - committing or threatening offences under Sections 6, 7, 8 or 9 with intent to coerce or intimidate the Government or public, advance sectarian/ethnic hatred, or advance proscribed organizations	Up to 14 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 50 million OR both	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
11	Hate speech - information advancing or likely to advance interfaith, sectarian or racial hatred	Up to 7 years imprisonment OR fine OR both (no fine ceiling stated)	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
12	Recruitment, funding and planning of terrorism through information systems	Up to 7 years imprisonment OR fine OR both (no fine ceiling stated)	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
13	Electronic forgery - input/alteration/deletion of data to create unauthentic data intended to be acted on as authentic. (2) Same offence relating to CI	(1) Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 250,000 OR both. (2) CI: up to 7 years OR fine up to PKR 5 million OR both	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
14	Electronic fraud - using or interfering with information systems/devices/data for wrongful gain or deceiving a person	Up to 2 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 10 million OR both	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
15	Making, obtaining or supplying a device or data for use in committing an offence under the Act	Up to 6 months imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 50,000 OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
16	Unauthorized use of identity information - obtaining, selling, possessing, transmitting or using another person's identity information	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 5 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
17	Unauthorized issuance of SIM cards etc. - selling/providing SIM, R-IUM or UICC without verifying the subscriber as approved by the PTA	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 500,000 OR both	Non-cognizable, but cognizable by the agency on written complaint by the Authority
18	Tampering etc. of communication equipment - changing or re-programming a device's unique identifier	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 1 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
19	Unauthorized interception - by technical means, with dishonest intention	Up to 2 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 500,000 OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
20	Offences against dignity of a natural person - intentionally and publicly displaying/transmitting information known to be false that intimidates or harms reputation or privacy	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 1 million OR both	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable

Sec	Offence	Penalty	Cognizance (s.43)
21	Offences against modesty of a natural person and minor - e.g. superimposing a face on sexually explicit images, sharing sexually explicit images/videos, sexual intimidation, or enticing a person to a sexually explicit act to harm or blackmail	(1) Up to 5 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 5 million OR both. (2) Where the victim is a minor: up to 7 years imprisonment AND fine up to PKR 5 million; repeat offender: 10 years and fine	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
22	Child pornography - producing, distributing, transmitting, procuring or possessing material depicting a minor (or person appearing to be a minor, or realistic images) in sexually explicit conduct, or disclosing a minor's identity	Imprisonment of fourteen years extendable up to twenty years (as worded in the Act) AND fine of not less than PKR 1 million	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
22A	Online grooming, solicitation and cyber enticement of a minor	Imprisonment of 5 to 10 years AND fine of PKR 500,000 to PKR 10 million	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
22B	Commercial sexual exploitation of children through information systems	Imprisonment of not less than 14 years, up to 20 years, AND fine of not less than PKR 1 million	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
22C	Use of information system for kidnapping, abduction or trafficking of a minor	Imprisonment of not less than 14 years, up to 20 years, AND fine of not less than PKR 1 million	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
23	Malicious code - writing, offering or distributing malicious code with intent to cause harm to a system or data	Up to 2 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 1 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
24	Cyber stalking - following/contacting despite disinterest, monitoring, spying causing fear or distress, or publishing photos/videos without consent to harm	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 1 million OR both. Minor victim: up to 5 years OR fine up to PKR 10 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
24A	Cyberbullying - posting or sending messages/pictures/videos via social media with intent to harass, threaten or target a person (penalty in sub-section (5) is expressed for child cyberbullying)	Imprisonment of 1 to 5 years AND fine of PKR 100,000 to PKR 500,000	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
25	Spamming - transmitting harmful, fraudulent, misleading, illegal or unsolicited information without permission; direct marketers must offer an unsubscribe option	Harmful/fraudulent/misleading/illegal information: up to 3 months imprisonment OR fine of PKR 50,000 up to PKR 5 million OR both. Unsolicited information or unsubscribe violation: first offence fine up to PKR 50,000; subsequent offences fine of PKR 50,000 up to PKR 1 million	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
26	Spoofing - dishonestly establishing a website or sending information with a counterfeit source intended to be believed authentic	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 500,000 OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
26A	False and fake information - intentionally disseminating information known or believed to be false or fake and likely to cause fear, panic, disorder or unrest	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 2 million OR both	Cognizable, non-bailable, non-compoundable
32(3) 48(2)	Non-licensee owner of information system violating traffic-data retention (s.32) or Federal Government/Authority directives (s.48)	First offence: fine up to PKR 10 million. Subsequent conviction: up to 6 months imprisonment OR fine OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable
41	Breach of confidentiality of personal information by a service provider or authorized officer with intent to cause harm or wrongful loss/gain	Up to 3 years imprisonment OR fine up to PKR 1 million OR both	Non-cognizable, bailable, compoundable

Corrections from the previous version (v1.0): The v1.0 table used section numbers and penalties that do not match the Act. Examples: identity theft is Section 16 (not 7); cyber stalking is Section 24 (not 8); spamming is Section 25 (not 9); spoofing is Section 26 (not 10); electronic forgery is Section 13 (not 11); electronic fraud is Section 14 (not 12); cyber terrorism is Section 10 (not 14); hate speech is Section 11 (not 16); child pornography is Section 22 (not 17). The Act has no offence titled "cyber harassment" at Section 22; the nearest provisions are Section 24 (cyber stalking) and Section 24A (cyberbullying). Section 3 carries a maximum of 3 months / PKR 50,000 (not 3 years / PKR 5 million). The Act does not prescribe capital punishment for cyber terrorism; the maximum is 14 years and/or a fine up to PKR 50 million. Offences missing from v1.0 (Sections 7, 8, 9, 12, 15, 17, 18, 19, 22A, 22B, 22C, 23 and 24A) are now included; Sections 22A-22C and 24A were added by Act No. XXXVII of 2023.

Note: The above is a summary reference of the statutory text. Actual sentences depend on judicial determination and case circumstances. Always consult a qualified legal professional for advice on specific cases.

8. Cybersecurity Best Practices for Pakistani Citizens

Preventing cybercrime begins with informed and cautious digital behaviour. NCCIA recommends the following practices for all citizens, businesses, and organizations.

Account & Password Security

- Use strong, unique passwords (minimum 12 characters with letters, numbers, symbols)
- Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on all critical accounts (banking, email, social media)
- Never share OTPs, passwords, or PINs with anyone - not even bank representatives
- Regularly update passwords and avoid reusing old ones

Online Financial Safety

- Verify the authenticity of any website before entering payment details
- Never transfer money to accounts on instructions received via SMS or call from unknown numbers
- Check your bank statement regularly for unauthorized transactions
- Do not click links in unsolicited SMS messages claiming to be from your bank

Social Media & Communication

- Be cautious about what personal information you share publicly online
- Do not accept friend requests from strangers; verify identities before sharing sensitive info
- Report fake accounts, impersonation, and abusive content to the platform and NCCIA
- Verify news and information before sharing to avoid spreading misinformation

Device & Data Security

- Keep your operating system, antivirus, and applications updated
- Do not install apps from unofficial sources; use only trusted app stores
- Take regular backups of important data
- Use encrypted communication apps for sensitive conversations

If You Become a Victim

- Do not delete any messages, emails, or transaction records - they are evidence
- Take screenshots of all suspicious communications with timestamps
- Immediately report to NCCIA at helpdesk@nccia.gov.pk or your nearest CCRC office
- Contact your bank immediately to freeze transactions if financial fraud is suspected
- For removal of harmful content about you (for example false information, intimate images, stalking or bullying content), an aggrieved person or a minor's guardian may also apply to the Authority under Sections 16, 20, 21, 22, 24 and 24A, and under Section 2C for fake information

9. Quick Reference - NCCIA Contacts & Resources

General Helpdesk Email	helpdesk@nccia.gov.pk
Official Website	https://www.nccia.gov.pk
HQ Location	Islamabad, Pakistan
Total CCRC Offices	15 Offices - covering all provinces and territories
Legal Mandate	PECA 2016 (Act No. XL of 2016), as amended by Act No. XXXVII of 2023 and Act No. II of 2025; NCCIA established under Section 29
Complaint Methods	Walk-in, Email (helpdesk or circle incharge), Visit HQ; the Investigation Rules 2018 (Rule 6(3)) also allow fax, telephone or other digital means
Post-Complaint	Physical verification required; failure to appear = complaint closed
For Blocked Accounts	Contact your bank for Enquiry Officer name, number & circle address
After 3 Unanswered Notices	Enquiry Officer may register FIR if evidence is sufficient
Content Removal / Blocking	Social Media Protection and Regulatory Authority (Sections 2A-2C, 37); appeals to the Social Media Protection Tribunal, then the Supreme Court

Provincial Coverage of NCCIA Circles

Region	Circle Offices
Punjab	Lahore, Gujranwala, Faisalabad, Multan, Rawalpindi
Sindh	Karachi, Hyderabad, Sukkur
KPK	Peshawar, Abbottabad, Dera Ismail Khan
Balochistan	Quetta, Gawadar
ICT	Islamabad
GB	Gilgit

This document is intended as a knowledge base for AI-assisted information retrieval (RAG). Legal content was verified against the Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act, 2016 (as amended up to Act No. II of 2025) and the Prevention of Electronic Crimes Investigation Rules, 2018 as compiled by the Sindh Judicial Academy Library (2025). For the most current information, always visit www.nccia.gov.pk or contact the helpdesk directly.